

In designating the **Governor Robert P. Casey Byway** in Lackawanna County in 2004, PennDOT Secretary Allen Biehler stated **"This designation will help highlight the beautiful countryside and rich history we have in Pennsylvania."** The Gov. Casey Byway became the tenth route in the Commonwealth to have an official Pennsylvania Byway designation, joining:

The Seaway Trail in Erie County;
Laurel Highlands Scenic Byway in Westmoreland & Fayette Counties;
The Historic National Road - U.S. Route 40 in Washington, Fayette & Somerset Counties;
Grandview Scenic Byway in Allegheny County;
Bucktail Trail in Elk, Cameron & Clinton Counties;
High Plateau Scenic Byway in Centre & Clinton Counties;
Kinzua Bridge Scenic Byway in McKean County;
Blue Route in Delaware & Montgomery Counties;
and the
Exton Bypass in Chester County.

Some may question the designation of limited access roadways as Pennsylvania Byways; they were designated at the request of the local communities wanting to preserve the viewsheds from these newly built roads. A Pennsylvania Byway designation ensured that preservation.

Pennsylvania Byways parallel National Scenic Byways, a program of the Federal Highway Administration. To learn more about National Scenic Byways, visit their web site at: **www.byways.org**

For questions concerning the Pennsylvania Byways Program or to obtain an application please contact:

PennDOT

Bureau of Planning and Research
PA Byways Coordinator
P.O. Box 3555
Harrisburg, PA 17105-3555



Information is also available online at:

www.dot.state.pa.us

Select **Special Interest Areas** on the Home Page;
then select **PA Byways** from the **Special Interest Areas** dropdown menu.

Department of Transportation
Allen D. Biehler P.E., Secretary
Commonwealth of Pennsylvania
Edward G. Rendell, Governor



Pennsylvania
Byways 

Program Information



Introduction

A little over a decade ago, the U.S. Congress authorized a program to help states and communities preserve the intrinsic qualities of unique roadway corridors. Under the National Scenic Byways Program, the U.S. Secretary of Transportation recognizes certain roads as National Scenic Byways or All-American Roads based on their intrinsic qualities.

Intrinsic Quality means archaeological, cultural, historic, natural, recreational, and scenic features that are considered representative, unique, irreplaceable, or distinctly characteristic of an area.

- **Archaeological** quality involves those characteristics of the scenic byway corridor that are physical evidence of historic or prehistoric life that are visible and capable of being inventoried and interpreted.
 - **Cultural** quality is evidence and expressions of the customs or traditions of a distinct group of people. Cultural features include, but are not limited to: crafts, music, dance, rituals, festivals, speech, food, special events, and vernacular architecture that are currently practiced.
 - **Historic** quality encompasses legacies of the past that are distinctly associated with physical elements of the landscape, whether natural or manmade, that are of such historic significance that they educate the viewer and stir an appreciation of the past.
 - **Natural** quality applies to those features in the visual environment that are in a relatively undisturbed state. These features predate the arrival of human populations, and may include geological formations, fossils, landforms, water bodies, vegetation and wildlife.
 - **Recreational** quality involves outdoor recreational activities directly associated with, and dependent upon, the natural and cultural elements of the corridor's landscape.
 - **Scenic** quality is the heightened visual experience derived from the view of natural and manmade elements of the visual environment.

States were encouraged to enact similar programs to both support the National Scenic Byways nomination process and to recognize road corridors that had regional rather than national appeal.

The Pennsylvania Department of Transportation initiated a scenic byways program for the Commonwealth and titled it Pennsylvania Byways – because many of our roadways exemplify more than the scenic intrinsic quality.

Pennsylvania Byways are designated in support of local planning efforts to:

- enhance and improve the visual impact of specific routes;
- maintain the natural resources and intrinsic qualities along specific routes; and
- educate residents and visitors on the history and culture of the Commonwealth.

Application Requirements

Each application for nomination must include:

1. Name and location of the road, beginning and ending terminus and length.
2. Names and address of the government unit submitting the application.
3. Resolutions of support from municipalities and counties along the proposed Byway.
4. Letters of support from applicable regional planning agencies (Metropolitan Planning Organizations, Rural Planning Organizations) and tourism promotion agencies.
5. Letters of support from members of the PA General Assembly whose districts are bisected by the proposed Byway.
6. A description of key resources along the corridor and how a Byway designation would complement other regional economic development strategies.
7. Demonstration of how the erection of new signs, displays or devices will be prohibited on the Byway in conformance with 23 U.S. Code section 131 (s), if the Byway is on the Interstate, Federal-Aid Primary (FAP) or National Highway Systems. Title 23-United States Code can be accessed at www.fhwa.dot.gov/legregs/title23.pdf.

Funding Opportunities

Nationally-designated and state-designated byways are eligible to receive funds from the National Scenic Byways Program for eligible projects on state or nationally designated byways.

Note, prior to seeking funds it is suggested that a Corridor Management Plan be developed.

Eligible Activities

- (1) An activity related to the planning, design, or development of a State scenic byway program.
- (2) Development and implementation of a corridor management plan to maintain the scenic, historical, recreational, cultural, natural, and archaeological characteristics of a byway corridor while providing for accommodation of increased tourism and development of related amenities.
- (3) Safety improvements to a State scenic byway, National Scenic Byway, or All-American Road to the extent that the improvements are necessary to accommodate increased traffic and changes in the types of vehicles using the highway as a result of the designation as a State scenic byway, National Scenic Byway, or All-American Road.
- (4) Construction along a scenic byway of a facility for pedestrians and bicyclists, rest area, turnout, highway shoulder improvement, overlook, or interpretive facility.
- (5) An improvement to a scenic byway that will enhance access to an area for the purpose of recreation, including water-related recreation.
- (6) Protection of scenic, historical, recreational, cultural, natural, and archaeological resources in an area adjacent to a scenic byway.
- (7) Development and provision of tourist information to the public, including interpretive information about a scenic byway.
- (8) Development and implementation of a scenic byway marketing program.